Julian Dierkes

Curriculum Vitae

dierkes@aim.rwth-aachen.de
labchameleon.github.io
Julian Dierkes

Education

2023–Oct. 2027 **Research Associate and Doctoral Candidate**, *RWTH Aachen University*, Chair for AI Methodology
Working on Automated RL supervised by Professor Holger Hoos

2025–2026 **Independent Research Visitor**, *Mila – Quebec AI Institute*
Conducted research on automated RL in collaboration with Professor Pablo Samuel Castro, fully funded by a competitive German Academic Exchange Service scholarship.

2020-2022 **Computer Science M.Sc.**, *RWTH Aachen University*
Minor Mathematics, Grade 1.1 (with distinction, GPA: 3.9/4.0)

2018–2019 **Study Abroad**, *Keio University*, Tokyo

2016–2020 **Computer Science B.Sc.**, *RWTH Aachen University*
Minor Mathematics, *Grade 1.4 (very good, GPA: 3.6/4.0)*

2008–2016 **Abitur**, *St. Michael secondary school*, Ahlen
Best student in Computer Science, *Grade 1.2 (very good, GPA: 3.8/4.0)*

Scientific Contributions

2026 Head organiser of the RLC Workshop on Automated Reinforcement Learning.

Lead authored *Dynamic Optimisation of Discount and Trace Decay for Value-Based Reinforcement Learning* under review at ICLR.

2025 Lead authored *Performance Prediction In Reinforcement Learning: The Bad And The Ugly* presented at EWLR and currently reviewed at TMLR. (pdf)

2024 Member of the German AI Grid initiative, connecting AI researchers in Europe and core member of AutoRL.org, disseminating and advancing AutoRL research.

Co-organising the ICML Workshop on Automated Reinforcement Learning.

Lead authored *ARLBench: Flexible and Efficient Benchmarking for Hyperparameter Optimization in Reinforcement Learning* accepted at DMLR. (pdf)

Lead authored *Combining Automated Optimisation of Reinforcement Learning Hyperparameters and Reward Shape* accepted at RLC 2024. (pdf)

2023 Co-authored the academic paper *Efficient Utilization of Large Pre-Trained Models for Low Resource ASR* published in the 2023 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing Workshops. The paper exclusively consists of the results of my Master's thesis. (pdf)

Work Experience

04.2023–12.2024 **Collaborator, ProKI Network**, *AI in Industrial Engineering Applications*
Collaborating on the exploration of AI for industrial engineering solutions

01.2021–11.2022 **Student Assistant**, *Automatic Speech Recognition*, RWTH Aachen University
Working on large-scale foundational models with cutting-edge self-supervised algorithms for feature representation learning

09.2019–12.2019 **Student Assistant**, *Machine Translation*, RWTH Aachen University
Working on sentence embedding learning for neural machine translation systems

Awards and Scholarships

2025 – 2026 DAAD IFI Fellowship, fully funded 10 month research visit at Mila, Montreal

2019 – 2022 Receiving the *Porsche* and *Deutschland Stipendium* scholarship

2015 First prize in the category Mathematics at the *Dr. Hans-Riegel Fachpreise 2015* awarded with 500 €

2015 Among the 5% best participants in the *Bundeswettbewerb Informatik 2015*, a Germany-wide Computer Science competition